
Appeals Policy

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1. PURPOSE

This policy sets out the grounds on which a student may appeal against an assessment decision on the Chainsaw Courses platform, and the procedure for submitting and considering an appeal. Overleaf Publishers Ltd is committed to a fair, transparent, and impartial appeals process that protects the integrity of the assessment framework whilst respecting the rights of individual learners.

2. GROUNDS FOR APPEAL

A student may submit an appeal on the following grounds:

- Procedural irregularity: The assessment was not conducted in accordance with the published Assessment Policy.
- Technical failure: A confirmed technical fault on the Platform materially affected the student's ability to complete an assessment.
- Adverse circumstances: Circumstances beyond the student's control that significantly affected their performance, and which were not and could not reasonably have been declared in advance.
- Marking error: The student believes there is a clear error in the automated marking of a quiz or mock examination.

Appeals on the grounds of disagreement with the assessed content (i.e., the student believes a correct answer has been marked incorrect) will only be upheld where there is a demonstrable error in the question, answer, or marking criteria.

3. STAGE 1 — INFORMAL REVIEW (0–10 WORKING DAYS)

In the first instance, the student should contact info@chainsawcourses.com within 10 working days of the assessment decision, setting out the grounds for the appeal and any supporting evidence. The assessment will be reviewed by a member of staff not involved in the original assessment. A written outcome will be issued within 10 working days.

4. STAGE 2 — FORMAL APPEAL (10–20 WORKING DAYS)

If the student is not satisfied with the Stage 1 outcome, a formal appeal may be submitted within 10 working days of receiving the Stage 1 response. The formal appeal will be reviewed by a senior member of staff or the Internal Verifier. A written outcome will be issued within 20 working days.

5. STAGE 3 — EXTERNAL APPEAL (IIRSM)

Where the appeal relates to an IIRSM-approved element of the course, and the student remains dissatisfied following Stage 2, the student may refer the matter to IIRSM at www.iirsm.org. IIRSM's decision on course-approval matters is final.

6. TIMESCALES



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STAGE	TIMESCALE
Stage 1 — Submission deadline	Within 10 working days of the assessment decision
Stage 1 — Outcome	Within 10 working days of submission
Stage 2 — Submission deadline	Within 10 working days of Stage 1 outcome
Stage 2 — Outcome	Within 20 working days of formal submission
Stage 3 — External (IIRSM)	As directed by IIRSM

7. OUTCOMES

Following a successful appeal, the assessment decision may be amended, the assessment may be re-taken, or an alternative remedy may be applied as appropriate. The outcome of an appeal will be recorded and used to inform quality improvement processes. Unsuccessful appeals will be communicated to the student with clear reasons.

To submit an appeal: info@chainsawcourses.com · Overleaf Publishers Ltd